

have been downloaded (which could take time depending on the number of messages), they are listed on the right pane. The message details displayed include the topic subject, the sender, and the number of lines, but most importantly the size. Large message sizes are indicative of the presence of downloadable attachments (since there are no other indications of the presence of an attachment). Right-clicking the message will offer the option to “Grab selected article”. Selecting this will download the message—if it is a text message a text file is saved, else the attached file is saved in the download folder. Grabbed messages are deleted from the queue, lest a user download the same message again. A user can read the message by clicking on the Read Article link in the context menu. But there are no options to reply.

The Batch tab in the right pane shows the messages that are being presently downloaded. A NNTP server can be searched for interesting groups by using the “All Groups” tab. GrabIt also allows searching for NGs online, by integrating the Usenet search tab (though, this requires you to register at shemes.com, for a price). Messages in an NG can be searched by clicking the Find button in the toolbar menu.

## Configuration

The configuration options can be accessed from the Settings link under the Edit menu.

Here the default download folder can be specified under the Folders tab. Under the Repair and Extract tab GrabIt’s archive repairing ability can be enabled. The multiple parts of a file have a par extension. The downloading and error checking of the files can be fine tuned under the Advanced tab.



GrabIt's host of options

## Comments

GrabIt is an excellent tool to grab binary files off Usenet. It’s support for Multi part files and inclusion of tools to repair corrupt